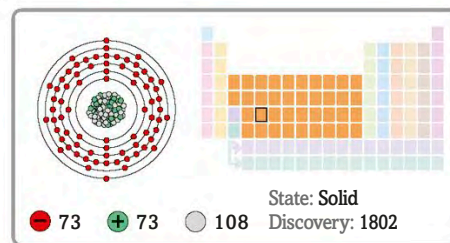


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Ta

Tantalum



Forms



The mineral has a dark, waxy surface.

These yellow crystals contain the mineral stibiotantalite.

The pure metal barely reacts with air, so stays shiny.

Rods of pure tantalum refined in a laboratory



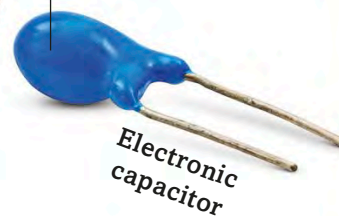
Uses

Artificial joint



The tantalum shell of this hip implant is lightweight and flexible.

Tantalum capacitors are used to store a lot of electric charge in small circuits, such as the ones inside mobile phones.



Electronic capacitor



Metallic watch

The case and strap of this watch are made of an alloy of tantalum, gold, and copper.

Tantalum is a hard metal named after **Tantalus**, a man from Greek mythology who was punished by the gods. It is extracted from a rare mineral called **tantalite**. This tough metal is not harmful to the human body, so it is used to make **artificial joints** and

other body implants. Tantalum powder is used in **capacitors** – devices used in electronic circuits to store electricity. This strong metal toughens **watches** made of softer, precious metals. Tantalum is also used to create strong turbine blades that do not corrode.